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Course Content

Know Your Faculty



Dr. Devavrat Shah

Andrew (1956) and Erna Viterbi Professor, MIT Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

Director, MIT Statistics and Data Science Center

Research Departments: MIT Laboratory for Information and Decision Systems (MIT LIDS), MIT Institute for Data, Systems, and Society (MIT IDSS), and the MIT Operations Research Center (MIT ORC)

Dr. Devavrat Shah has earned a Ph.D. in Computer Science from Stanford University under the supervision of Balaji Prabhakar. He has received prestigious awards along with his career such as the President of India Gold Medal, 2005 INFORMS George B. Dantzig best dissertation award, the 2008 ACM SIGMETRICS Rising Star award for his work on network scheduling algorithms, the 2010 Erlang Prize from INFORMS, which is given to a young researcher for outstanding contributions to applied probability, as well as various publication awards. He is a distinguished young alumnus of his alma-mater IIT Bombay. He co-founded Celect, Inc. in 2013 to commercialize his research at MIT.

His research is focused on the theory of large complex networks, which includes network algorithms, stochastic networks, network information theory, and large-scale statistical inference.

- Professional website: https://idss.mit.edu/staff/devavrat-shah/
- Personal website: http://www.mit.edu/~devavrat/



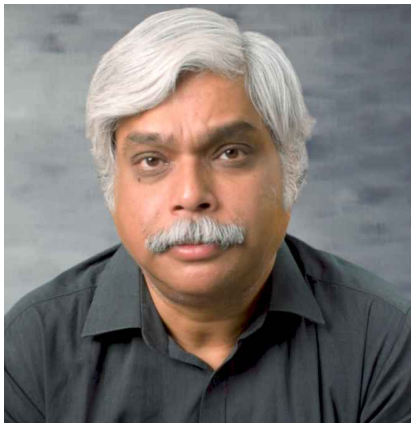
Matthew Graziano

Senior Data Science Manager, Progressive Insurance

Experienced Data Scientist with a demonstrated history of working in the insurance industry. Skilled in Management, Data Analytics, Python, R, and data strategy.

Matthew Graziano is heading a team comprising of full stack data scientists and engineers to develop predictive models, APIs, and applications for Progressive's service. He has played a crucial role in Progressive's response to the changes in driving behavior and economic conditions due to the COVID-19 pandemic, including lockdowns, work from home, supply chain disruptions, etc. Under his leadership, the team has enhanced the existing models resulting in sustained growth and profitability. His efforts have ensured an aligned response across various business units such as pricing, claims, control, product, and R&D to the changing situation.

Under his leadership, Matthew Graziano has helped in bringing about a cultural shift in the organization towards a probabilistic rate-making approach. He has encouraged decision-makers to consider the variations in loss estimates and has emphasized the importance of providing stable rates over time to ensure sustained growth and profitability in targeted business segments. He has also taken an active role in providing developmental, mentoring, and technical training opportunities to analysts, interns, and data scientists. He has focused on identifying their strengths, curating mission statements, and helping individuals plan strategically to achieve their personal and career goals. Additionally, he has influenced senior leaders and product managers to adopt a global rate-making strategy and leverage predictive models in pricing decisions. He has done this by effectively communicating the technical intricacies of the models and translating them into business insights.



Dr. Abhinanda Sarkar

Faculty Director, Great Learning

Dr. Abhinanda Sarkar is the Academic Director at Great Learning for Data Science and Machine Learning Programs. Dr. Sarkar received his B.Stat. and M.Stat. degrees from the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI) and a Ph.D. in Statistics from Stanford University. He has taught applied mathematics at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), been on the research staff at IBM, led Quality, Engineering Development, and Analytics functions at General Electric (GE), served as Associate Dean at the MYRA School of Business, and co-founded OmiX Labs.

Dr. Sarkar's publications, patents, and technical leadership have been in applying probabilistic models, statistical data analysis, and machine learning to diverse areas such as experimental physics, computer vision, text mining, wireless networks, e-commerce, credit risk, retail finance, engineering reliability, renewable energy, and infectious diseases, His teaching has mostly been on statistical theory, methods, and algorithms, together with application-oriented topics such as financial modeling, quality management, and data mining.

Dr. Sarkar is a certified Master Black Belt in Lean Six Sigma and Design for Six Sigma. He has been a visiting faculty at Stanford and ISI and continues to teach at the Indian Institute of Management (IIM-Bangalore) and the Indian Institute of Science (IISc). Over the years, he has designed and conducted numerous corporate training sessions for technology and business professionals. He is a recipient of the ISI Alumni Association Medal, the IBM Invention Achievement Awards, and the Radhakrishnan Mentor Award from GE India.

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